



Managing Staff Performance

Whether you have one part-time worker or a hundred full-timers, your staff will have a huge impact on your business. When employees perform well and realize their potential, they make a big difference to the success of the business.

Setting expectations

As a business leader, one of your most essential tasks is to assemble and maintain a high-performing staff. The keys to this are threefold: recruiting the right people, making sure that everyone knows what you expect of them, and regularly monitoring performance. If an

employee is underperforming, you will need to act before the issue becomes more serious.

It is good practice to set out your expectations of performance levels on the first day that someone starts work. Take time to talk to the new recruit, get to know them, and let them know they can speak to you if

they do not understand something or if they encounter a problem. It is better to know that something is awry early on than to discover it later simply because someone has been too hesitant to approach you. Mistakes happen. It is important to learn from them and make sure they do not happen again.

CONDUCTING PERFORMANCE APPRAISALS



G Hold a formal, structured discussion about personal performance with each member of staff at least once a year. Meet with them in private to talk about how their work is going. Use the meeting to agree on goals, monitor progress, and discuss concerns.

- › **Give the employee** plenty of advance warning of the meeting's time, location, and duration.
- › **Make it a conversation** rather than an interrogation.
- › **Use the time** to discuss the employee's ambitions and training needs, as well as their immediate work.
- › **Allow time** for them to give feedback to you about what is working for them and what is not.
- › **Do not shy away** from discussing any performance problems you have picked up.
- › **Make notes** to summarize the meeting—including any actions that have been agreed on—and send them to the employee.